

What to Do When AI Gets Your Business Wrong: Correcting AI Misinformation

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AI engines sometimes get businesses wrong — wrong founding date, wrong services, wrong location. When they do, they state the errors with the same confidence they state facts. Here is how to respond.

Quick Answer:

When an AI engine generates inaccurate information about your business, the correction path has two layers: update the authoritative sources the engine is likely drawing from (Google Business Profile, your website, major directories, your structured data), and use each platform's feedback mechanism to flag specific inaccuracies. Prevention is more effective than correction — the richer and more consistent your authoritative source layer, the less room AI engines have to generate inaccurately.

When the AI is confidently wrong

AI engines are trained to produce fluent, confident responses. This is what makes them useful — and what makes their errors particularly damaging. When a traditional search result is wrong, a user can see the source and evaluate credibility. When an AI engine states something incorrectly about your business, it does so in the same clear, authoritative voice it uses for facts.

AI misinformation about businesses happens regularly, it often goes undetected because business owners are not monitoring their AI representation, and when it does occur it influences buyer decisions in the moments before contact.

Why AI engines get businesses wrong

Outdated source data. AI engines retrieve from the indexed web, and the web contains outdated content. An old press release mentioning a former office location. An archived directory listing with an outdated phone number. When an AI retrieval engine pulls this content, it may reproduce the outdated information as fact.

Entity confusion. AI engines sometimes confuse one entity with a similar one — especially when business names are not unique, when businesses share a category and geography, or when a name change has occurred. The engine merges or confuses the entities, attributing information from one to the other.

Hallucination in training-based models. When training data is thin or ambiguous about a specific business, the model sometimes fills in gaps with plausible-sounding but inaccurate information. A business with limited structured online presence is particularly vulnerable.

Aggregator distortion. Some third-party sites aggregate business information automatically, sometimes incorrectly. If an AI engine retrieves from these aggregators, it may reproduce their errors.

How to discover AI misinformation about your business

The manual query protocol. Regularly query major AI engines — ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews, Gemini — with your business name and "tell me about [business name]." Read responses carefully for factual accuracy: Do they name the right services? The right location? Any inaccuracy should be documented and corrected.

Perplexity source inspection. Because Perplexity shows its sources, querying for your business name reveals which specific URLs are being used to construct information about you. If you see an outdated source being cited, you can address the inaccuracy directly.

Brand mention alerts. Set up Google Alerts for your exact business name. Some AI-generated content gets published to the web and shows up in alert notifications.

The correction playbook

Layer 1: Update your own authoritative sources immediately.

Your Google Business Profile is the highest-priority authoritative source. If the misinformation relates to services, location, hours, or description, update your GBP to reflect correct information accurately and specifically.

Your website's structured data is the second priority. Organization schema with accurate, current information — name, address, phone, services, founding date — is a machine-readable authoritative declaration. Update your schema to explicitly correct any field being misrepresented.

Your website's About page, Contact page, and Services pages are the human-readable layer that retrieval engines read. Update them with clear, specific language.

Layer 2: Address the specific erroneous sources.

If Perplexity is citing a specific outdated source, go to that source and update it. For directory listings, claim the listing and correct the data. For press coverage with outdated information, contact the publication and request a correction.

Layer 3: Use platform feedback mechanisms.

- ChatGPT: Use the thumbs-down feedback, then "Share Feedback" to describe the inaccuracy specifically.
- Google AI Overviews: Use the "More about this result" feedback option to report inaccurate citations.
- Perplexity: Use the feedback option to flag specific inaccurate responses.
- Gemini: Report via the thumbs-down and "Report" options on specific responses.

Building the prevention layer

The same signals that drive AI visibility also reduce AI misinformation risk. A rich, consistent, authoritative source layer leaves less room for errors to fill.

Entity richness. The more authoritative information that exists about your business from credible sources, the less the AI engine needs to infer. Businesses with thin online presence are most vulnerable to hallucination.

Source dominance for your business name. If you search your own business name and the top results are all authoritative, accurate representations of your business, an AI engine pulling those results will likely produce accurate descriptions.

Regular content updates. Fresh content dates signal currency to retrieval engines. Regular publishing of accurate content keeps your owned sources current and maintains their authority in retrieval.

What to do when you cannot fully correct the misinformation

Some AI misinformation cannot be corrected immediately. Training-layer misinformation in large language models may persist until the next training cycle, which can be months away.

In these cases, create enough current, accurate, well-indexed content about your business that the authoritative signal overwhelms the inaccurate one in retrieval probability. A GBP updated last week, an About page refreshed last month, a press mention from this quarter — these outcompete a directory listing from three years ago in a retrieval engine's source selection.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I legally compel an AI company to correct misinformation about my business?

The legal landscape for AI-generated business misinformation is evolving. In most jurisdictions as of mid-2026, there are limited grounds for compelling correction the way defamation law applies to human publication. The practical path remains updating authoritative sources and using platform feedback mechanisms. If the misinformation is causing significant business harm, consult an attorney familiar with AI-related reputational issues.

Q: How long does it take for AI engines to update after I correct my information?

For retrieval-based engines like Perplexity, corrections can take effect within days to weeks once updated sources are indexed. For Google AI Overviews, GBP updates often reflect in days while website content changes may take weeks. For ChatGPT's training-layer responses, corrections only propagate in future training cycles, which may be months away.

Q: An AI is claiming my business closed when it didn't. What do I do first?

First, update your Google Business Profile immediately to explicitly state that you are open, with current hours and a recent business update post. Second, update your website homepage and Contact page with a clear, current statement that you are open. Third, add a post to your GBP specifically addressing your open status. Simultaneously, use ChatGPT and Google's feedback mechanisms to flag the specific error.

Q: What if the AI is attributing a negative experience that didn't happen to my business?

If an AI is citing a specific review or source as the basis for a negative characterization, address that source directly: report false reviews through the platform's review flagging process. If the negative description appears to be generated without a cited source, build authoritative positive content that contextualizes your actual customer experience — case studies, verified testimonials — and use platform feedback to flag the inaccurate characterization.

Q: Is it worth hiring someone to monitor and correct AI misinformation for my business?

For businesses in competitive categories or with significant online reputations, yes. The cost of undetected AI misinformation typically exceeds the cost of systematic monitoring. Hey Pearl's platform includes AI representation monitoring as a core function for exactly this reason.

Q: Can competitors seed AI misinformation about my business intentionally?

In principle, yes — negative content published by third parties can be retrieved by AI engines and contribute to negative or inaccurate descriptions. The defense is the same as for accidental misinformation: authoritative source dominance, monitoring, and rapid response. If you have evidence that a competitor is deliberately creating false content, that may have legal remedies independent of the AI visibility question.

Conclusion

AI misinformation about businesses is a practical problem with a practical solution: build the authoritative source layer robust enough that accurate information dominates what AI engines retrieve, monitor your AI representation regularly, and correct inaccuracies at the source when they occur. The businesses most vulnerable to persistent AI misinformation are those with thin or inconsistent online presence — the same businesses vulnerable to all the other AI visibility challenges. Building the entity foundation is simultaneously your visibility strategy and your misinformation prevention strategy.